PART II.

THE RATIONALE OF CURE.

ELECTRICAL DIAGNOSIS.

The office of electricity as a diagnostic is only beginning to be appreciated. Indeed, no less a practitioner than Doctor Tibbitts, author of a book on medical electricity, limits this office far more closely than the facts warrant, viz., to the mere distinctions between the several forms of paralysis, by the comparative effects of galvanic and faradic currents. These are indeed of capital importance, both in diagnosis and treatment, and may as well be stated here in brief, after which a wider range of view may be profitably taken. To begin with, muscles and nerves are normally responsive, to some extent, to all varieties of electricity. Deficient or excessive response argues a corresponding nutritive and functional activity.

The object, then, is to obtain the vital response to the currents, in the forms known as electro-sensibility and electro-contractility.

The activity of the battery being always known, the vital response is measured, either by similar portions of the patient's sound parts, or those of another similar person. The ball of the thumb is a good